Introduction

Rani and Ravi went to vegetable market with their mother. They saw variety of fresh green vegetables with attractive colours. Their mother bought cauliflower, cabbage and raddish. Ravi asked his mother 'Mom, do all the vegetables grow under the soil?' His mother answered, "No Ravi, we get some vegetable from stem, some from roots. Even some flowers are used for cooking". Rani and Ravi were surprised to know that vegetables are from different parts of the plant. After returning home they sorted out all vegetables from the bag and discussed which vegetable is from stem, which is from root and which is from flower. Their mother collected keezhanelli, curry leaves, and coriander leaves from the garden and said that the purpose of using these leaves in cooking is to add medicinal value and aroma. Discuss with your teacher about the pictures given below.






Biology is a natural science concerned with the study of life and living organisms, including their structure and functions. The living world comprises of plants and animals. Plants can prepare food by themselves, grow in size, and reproduce. Various parts of the plants are used as food, medicine, wood, and shelter.

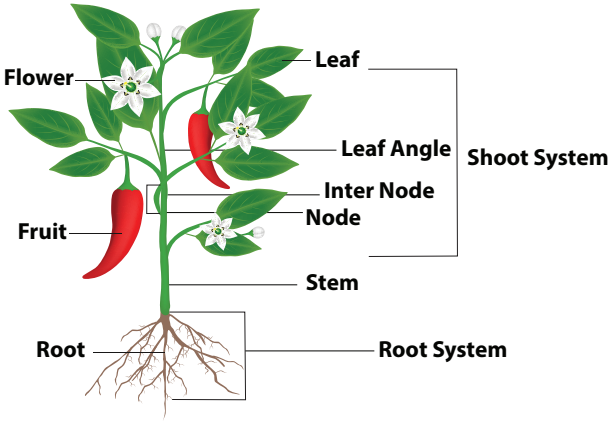
4.1 Plant forms and functions

Our body is made up of many organs. Similarly the plant body is also made up of several organs such as **root**, **stem, leaves** and **flowers**. Plants are of many forms and many colours, yet they are alike in some manner. That is, they all have stems and leaves above the ground which we can see easily and roots below the ground.

As shown in the picture, a flowering plant consists of two main parts. They are,

1. Root system.
2. Shoot system

Let us learn about them in detail.



1. Root System

The underground part of the main axis of a plant is known as **root**. It lies below the surface of the soil. Root has no nodes and internodes. It has a root cap at the tip. A tuft of root hairs is found just above the root tip. Roots are positively geotropic in nature